petitions, writing newspaper articles and organizing strikes. Over the course of twenty years, he established a reputation for himself as a principled and committed campaigner for freedom both in South Africa and back home.

A new path to freedom

In 1915, Gandhi returned to India. At the time, the nationalist Congress was divided on whether to pursue their goals through violent resistance or through cooperation with the British. Gandhi suggested a third path, one defined by non-violent non-cooperation. And so, from 1920 onwards, Indians all over the country were encouraged to boycott British-made goods as well as British-run schools, colleges, jobs and courts. Also, the Congress had until then been dominated by the educated elite. Gandhi encouraged people from a variety of castes, classes and backgrounds to participate in the nationalist movement. From 1934, Gandhi also asked people to engage in civil disobedience, which involved not paying taxes and not following unfair British laws, in order to show the British that Indians would not accept a government biased against them.



Gandhian ideals

After his return, Gandhi travelled across India, and soon realized that the British were only one of many oppressive forces at work across the land—untouchability, religious conflict, poverty and a lack of education were all issues that needed to be dealt with in order for Indians to live truly free lives.